

The Amazing Tomatoboy!

**Dangerous Dave!
With tomatoes!
By a twelve-year-
old! More!
Exclamations!
Please!**

Nimish Chandiramani

Everyone loves a good tomato. They're a wonderful round shape, red, healthy, and look excellent when generously splattered over the faces of bad performers. They've inspired everything from cheesy action movies to Web portals, confirming what we've believed all along—anything with tomatoes is always fun. Disappointingly, though, there is a shortage of tomato-inspired games out in the world.

Imagine our joy, then, when a young reader sent in a little game called *Go Tomatoes!* to put on this month's CD for our readers (which we have). Apart from being one of a rare breed of tomato-games, this one caught our fascination because it was *created* by said young reader!

The Man Boy

To the untrained eye, all twelve-year-olds are quite the same—small, a little squeaky, a little annoying, and will probably get off your back if you put them in front of a video game. But every once in a while, when the planets align themselves just right and the sixth moon of Saturn sneakily enters the fifth house of Alpha Centauri, you come across one like Shashank H R. Not content with just playing them, he *creates* games of his own to satisfy his friends' (and now our) daily requirement of amusing activity.

This sixth-standard student from Bangalore likes playing racing games like the *Need For Speed* series, and also takes in a healthy dose of real-life games such as table tennis. He's also learning MS Office and Macromedia Flash on his own!

